soldiers in Indian-administered Kashmir. However, none of these aspiring jihadis ever reached the Afghan front. They did not train with Lashkar for very long either and the instruction they received was limited to practicing with small arms, anti-aircraft guns and rocket-propelled grenades at Lashkar's Masada and bin Masood camps.[162] In other words, the available evidence does not suggest they received instruction specifically for urban terrorism. Nor does Lashkar appear to have made any effort to deploy them to Indian-administered Kashmir or to Afghanistan. Instead, several of the men from Virginia became nodes in a logistical network, working with Mohammed Ajmal Khan [a.k.a. Abu Khalid], a British Lashkar operative who was later convicted of using money raised in the UK to provide all manner of military kit for the group. This included Kevlar body armor, firearms and hi-tech surveillance equipment.[163] He is believed to have undertaken this procurement mission at the behest of Sajid Mir, the Lashkar commander in charge of overseeing transnational operatives. Ajmal Khan made multiple visits to the US in 2002 and 2003, where Chandia, Masoud Khan and Seifullah Chapman assisted him in his efforts to acquire equipment for Lashkar.[164] Most of the men involved in the Virginia Jihad Network were convicted on or plead guilty to various charges relating to their preparation for jihad, training with Lashkar and support given to the group.[165]

Although the men from Virginia were used in a support capacity, one concern about such networks is that their purpose can change over time. In addition to using the Virginia network for procurement, Sajid Mir also asked two of the trainees to undertake missions involving information gathering as well as the dissemination of propaganda.[166] This suggests Mir was interested in expanding Lashkar's networks in the US. Masoud Khan told the US Federal Bureau of Investigation in 2004 that at one point the group also asked him to perform surveillance on a chemical plant in Maryland.[167] Precisely what Lashkar or elements within it planned to do with this information is unclear, but it highlights the potential risk that such transnational networks pose. When authorities arrested Khan in May 2003, they found him in possession of automatic weapons, a document entitled 'The Terrorist's Handbook,' containing instructions for the manufacture and use of explosives, as well as a photograph of the FBI's Washington headquarters.[168]